

SQL

DELETE vs TRUNCATE vs DROP



Pradeep M
@pradeep-m-analyst



**For example, we have a table named
'employee' here.**

EmpID	Name	Department
1	Pradeep	Data Engineering
2	Naveen	Business Intelligence
3	Aditya	Data Governance



1

DELETE

This command is used to remove specific rows from a table based on specified conditions.

Let's remove "Aditya" from the employee table.



```
DELETE FROM employee WHERE EmpID = 3;
```

Output

EmpID	Name	Department
1	Pradeep	Data Engineering
2	Naveen	Business Intelligence

**2**

TRUNCATE

This command is used to remove all rows from a table but not the structure of the table.



```
TRUNCATE TABLE employee;
```

Output

EmpID	Name	Department



3

DROP

This command will permanently delete the "employee" table along with all its data and structure.



```
DROP TABLE employee;
```


Output



In Summary

- DELETE is to delete **specific rows** from the table
- TRUNCATE is to **remove all rows** from the table
- DROP is to delete the **entire table**



Can we retrieve our data after executing DELETE, DROP, or TRUNCATE commands?

With DELETE, we can typically recover data if the transaction hasn't been committed yet.

With TRUNCATE or DROP, data cannot be recovered once the command has been executed.

Did you find this valuable?

Show some love with a like and inspire
me to create more!



Pradeep M
@pradeep-m-analyst

